

money requires do not allow you to have instant gratification. If you want something now and are not willing to wait, gambling may seem like the perfect solution.

Margot always took chances. She saw money as a way to get herself out of her boring life. She married early, right out of high school, and with her husband Ernie she immediately started a family. Ernie was her high school sweetheart and their life in suburban Chicago proved predictable. She was now twenty-two years old with two young children, and she daydreamed frequently about living a luxurious lifestyle. She reasoned that if she got enough money, she could change her life. Regrettably, this plan was not consistent with a job that had a stable salary. Margot always chose jobs that were based almost entirely on commission. These jobs had the possibility of earning big money, but more often than not they made her no money.

Margot's risky attitude extended to the stock market. When she had money to invest (in those rare cases that a deal did go through), she did so in high-risk stocks. These investments promised that her shares would escalate in value quickly. She was sure that this company in Texas would strike oil any day or this new Internet stock would skyrocket in value, but rarely did she even get back her original investment. Eventually, gambling became an addiction that caused Margot to lose control over her life. Her view of money as a source of "freedom" to allow her choices ultimately led to this addiction.

Her husband Ernie had tried to be supportive, but one day he forced her to see a credit counselor after discovering that she had gambled away all the money they had saved for Christmas presents. He didn't know what he was going to tell the kids when they discovered there weren't any gifts under the tree.

As the counselor went over Margot's expenses, it was easy to discover where the money went. She spent hundreds of dollars monthly on lottery tickets, went weekly to the racetracks

